

BEFORE YOU QUOTE

Why good tattoo inquiries go quiet after the price - and what to change before your next quote.

INQUIRY > CLARITY > ESTIMATE > DECISION

THE QUOTE IS ONE MOMENT.

The client experience starts before it.

THE QUOTE IS NOT ALWAYS THE PROBLEM.

Some clients simply cannot afford the project, are not ready, or are not a fit. That is normal.

But sometimes a suitable client disappears because the conversation reached price before the project - or the next decision - was clear.

WHAT YOU SEE

- They liked my work.
- They seemed serious.
- I sent the number.
- Then they went quiet.

WHAT MAY BE MISSING

- A defined tattoo project
- Enough context to estimate
- A specific next decision
- A follow-up path if timing changes

BEFORE YOU LOWER YOUR PRICE, CHECK:

WHAT HAPPENED BEFORE YOU SENT IT?

If the project was clear, the estimate was appropriate, and the next step was obvious, the answer may simply be no. The goal is clarity - not forcing every inquiry into a booking.

STOP ASKING

**"WILL THIS PERSON
CHOOSE ME?"**

START ASKING

**"ARE WE A GOOD FIT
FOR EACH OTHER AND
FOR THIS PROJECT?"**

That changes what you do next.

- You gather the information needed to understand the tattoo.
- You do not spend the same time on every inquiry.
- You present the estimate as part of a defined project.
- You know what happens if the answer is yes, not now, or no.

SAME QUESTION. DIFFERENT PROCESS.

Illustrative example - not a script you have to copy.

CLIENT "How much for a sleeve?"

A / PRICE WITHOUT A DEFINED PROJECT

"Sleeves are usually [price]. Let me know."

The number may be accurate, but the client still has no clear decision about a specific project.

B / CLARIFY WHAT YOU ARE ESTIMATING

"What are you thinking for the sleeve? Send me the main idea, a couple of references, and whether you mean shoulder to wrist or a smaller section. That will help me give you a useful estimate."

This is not a trick for hiding the price. If you use starting ranges, share them when useful. The point is to make sure the eventual estimate refers to an actual project and has a clear next step.

FIVE THINGS TO CHECK BEFORE YOU QUOTE.

01 IS THE PROJECT DEFINED?

Do I understand the idea, placement, scale, direction, and anything that materially changes the estimate?

02 HAS THE CLIENT PARTICIPATED?

Have they supplied the information I actually need, or am I doing all of the work while they stay passive?

03 IS PRICE BEING ASKED TO DO TOO MUCH?

Am I sending a number before the client understands what project I am estimating and what happens next?

04 CAN I PRESENT THE ESTIMATE SIMPLY?

Project. Estimated investment. Deposit. Next step. The estimate does not need an apology or a long defense.

05 IF THEY PAUSE, WHAT STATUS IS IT?

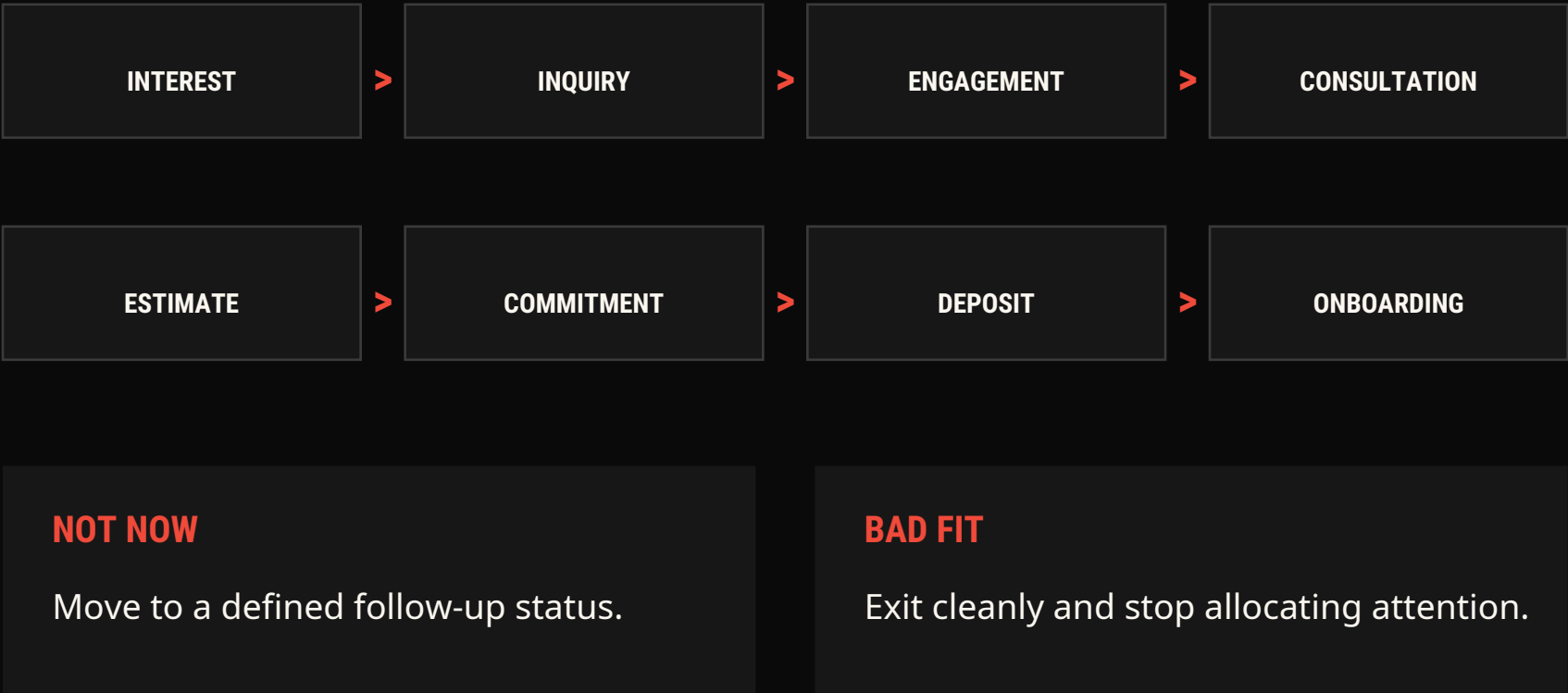
Not now, no response, and bad fit are different. Decide whether the lead belongs in follow-up or should be closed.

NOT EVERY GHOST IS PREVENTABLE.

The goal is a process that makes the decision clearer for both sides.

THE PROCESS SHOULD DO MORE OF THE WORK.

Each stage has one job. It does not need to feel corporate or scripted.



TRY THIS ON ONE RECENT INQUIRY

Open a conversation that went quiet. What was the last clear decision you asked the client to make? Was it about a defined project - or had you only sent a number?

THE QUICK CHECK

- ☐ Project defined
- ☐ Estimate fits the scope
- ☐ Next action is explicit
- ☐ Pause has a status

STOP LETTING GOOD PROJECTS DIE IN YOUR DMs.

The sleeve that went quiet. The project buried in messages. Put a process behind the inquiries you're already getting.

RECOMMENDED

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